T/TH 12:30-1:45PM I Car Barn 301

MEDHUM1101 Sec.01

Intro to Medical Humanities

CLASS DESCRIPTION

Who Cares?

The nineteenth century was a time of upheaval for the practice of medicine in Britain. Alongside the rise of the physician as a respected and credentialed professional, Britain saw the establishment of the fields of modern nursing and psychiatry, the acceptance of germ theory and the widespread use of vaccination, and the first English publication on medical ethics. As individual practitioners became medical experts and authorities, the medical gaze displaced older frameworks of caring– including those that had been integral to cultural understandings of health, wellbeing, and personhood. In this course, students will explore this shift in the ethics of care by asking who was obligated to care for and about others, and who was expected not to? What even counted as good to bad care? And how does the institutionalization of medicine in the nineteenth century continue to shape how we understand the medical relationship today? Some class concepts include: narrative medicine and the doctor/patient relationship; industrialization, pollution, and contagion; and population control and biopower.

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

LINDSEY E. R. O'NEIL, PHD

Office Hours by appointment (In person or Zoom)

Think of my office hours as an extension of the classroom. I am happy to discuss any aspect of your writing or reading, as well as any questions you may have about class procedures or requirements. You may "stop in" my [Zoom] office whenever you like. I ask that you give me at least 15 min to figure out where my laptop and Zoom login is when scheduling.

CLASS POLICIES

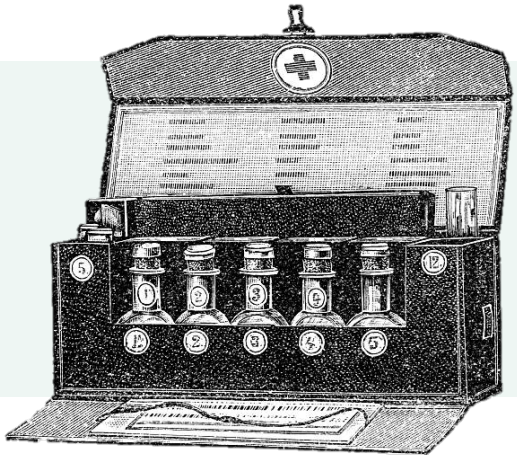
ATTENDANCE & PARTICIPATION: This class is *primarily discussion based*. You will be expected to come prepared to discuss the day's assigned text. This means you should be contributing *substantially* to discussion in each class period. You are also required to bring the assigned text to class on the day it is to be discussed. If you miss class for any reason, it will be your responsibility to find out what you missed and how you can make up the work from another student.

The class' participation rubric can be found on Canvas; more information on Georgetown's Attendance/Absence Policy can be found online.

LATE WORK: Assignments are due on the date and time designated on the course syllabus. Late papers will be marked down one-half letter grade per day late, including weekends. If you must submit a late paper, you should contact me the day the paper is due.

TECHNOLOGY: You may use a laptop or tablet for PDFs posted on Canvas. If these technologies become a distraction, I reserve the right to revoke this privilege. The first disruption will result in a warning; The second time your phone disrupts class, you will bring cookies in for the entire class the next class meeting. *Lack of attention due to technology will also be factored into your participation grade.*

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY: Plagiarism, whether it is submitting someone else's work as your own, submitting your own work completed for another class, using AI without pre-approval, or otherwise violating the University's code of Academic Integrity, will not be tolerated. Please contact me before submitting work if you are uncertain of the definition of these academic violations and their potential consequences.



ASSIGNMENTS

PARTICIPATION:
25% of Final Grade.
Active and repeated participation in class and group work. This includes bringing in questions, observations, passages that confused you, and so on [SOAP Notes]. Texts and drafts should be brought on the days they are assigned.

SOAP NOTES (3):
Completion grade/30% total
At the beginning of the semester, you will sign up in groups of 2-3. By 12 pm on your assigned date, you will post your SOAP Note on our class GoogleDoc. Instructions for the SOAP Note will be covered on the first day of class and on Canvas.

REFLECTIVE PROJECT (3):
15% each/45% of Final Grade.
These projects can take the form of: a literary close reading, a response essay to a provided question, or an unessay project. In-depth explanations of the types of projects can be found on Canvas. I am also open to discussing other options; bring all ideas to me!

PAPER FORMAT:
Unless otherwise indicated, the standard format is:

- double-spaced throughout (with no extra spaces between paragraphs)
- Arial/Times New Roman/Calibri (12 point, no italics except for titles or emphasis)
- one-inch margins on all sides, left justified
- your name, my name, the section number for the course
- title of the paper center justified
- numbered pages

When you cite information, you should follow MLA style guidelines.

COURSE SCHEDULE

Week 1 Introductions & Foundations
TH Aug 28 Syllabus Day (feat. painful ice breakers).

Week 2 Medicine & Power I
T Sept 2 No class (Monday schedule).
TH Sept 4 Cole et al., "Medicine and Power" (2014); Reverby, "Ethical Failures and History Lessons" (2012).

Week 3 The Physician I
T Sept 9 Rabinow & Rose, "Biopower Today" (2006); Odden, "'Able and intelligent medical men meeing together': The Victorian Railway Crash, Medical Jurisprudence, and the Rise of Medical Authority" (2003).
TH Sept 11 Sterne," Mediate Auscultation, the Stethoscope, and the 'Autopsy of the Living': Medicine's Acoustic Culture" (2001); Doyle, "The Adventure of the Norwood Builder" (1903).

Week 4 Populations I
T Sept 16 Durbach, "Germs, Dirt, and the Constitution" (2005); Harrison, Differences of Degree: Representations of India in British Medical Topography" (2012).
TH Sept 18 Visiting instructor Dr. Sneha Daya, MD.

Week 5 Care Work I
T Sept 23 Schaffer "Ethics of Care & the Care Community" (2021); Nightingale, *Notes on Nursing: What It Is, and What It Is Not* (1860).
TH Sep 25 Seacole, *Wonderful Adventures of Mrs. Seacole in Many Lands*, Ch. 1-3 (1847).

Week 6 Care Work II
T Sept 31 Selections from Nishida, "Differential Debilitation and Capacitation" (2022); Seacole, Ch. 4-6.
TH Oct 2 Seacole, Ch. 7-10.

Week 7 Care Work III
T Oct 7 Seacole, Ch. 11-14.
TH Oct 9 Walters, "...Mary Seacole, Feeling, and the Imperial Body" (2020); Seacole, Ch. 15-End.

Reflective Project 1 due Sunday, Oct 12th, at 11:59PM.

Week 8 Disease I
T Oct 14 Cole, et al., "Constructing Disease" (2014); Conrad & Barker, "The Social Construction of Illness: Key Insights and Policy Implications" (2010).
TH Oct 16 Netherland & Hensen, "The War on Drugs That Wasn't" (2016). Rossetti, "Jenny" (1870).

ACCESSIBILITY

Your success in the class is important to me. If there are circumstances that may affect your performance in this class, please let me know as soon as possible so that we can work together to develop strategies for adapting assignments to meet both your needs and the requirements of the course. If your name or pronouns need to be corrected, please let me know. If you have questions or concerns regarding physical, digital, or course accessibility, you may also contact arc@georgetown.edu or visit https://academicsupport.georgetown.edu/disability/.

COURSE CONTENT NOTE: Due to the nature of this course, we will be discussing historical events and texts that may be disturbing, even traumatizing, to some students. If you ever feel the need to step outside during one of these discussions, either for a short time or for the rest of the class session, you may always do so without academic penalty (You will, however, be responsible for any material you miss. If you do leave the room for a significant time, please make arrangements to get notes from another student or see me individually.)

COURSE SCHEDULE

Gilbert, Introduction from *The Citizen's Body* (2007).

Week 9 Disability

T Oct 21 Davis, Introduction to the *Disability Studies Reader* (2013); Manchen, *The Great God Pan* (1897).

TH Oct 23 Cohen, "Monster Culture (Seven Theses)" (1996);); Manchen, *The Great God Pan* (1897).

Week 10 Debility

T Oct 28 Nixon, Introduction to *Slow Violence* (2011);

TH Oct 30 *The 2022 report of the* Lancet *Countdown on health and climate change* (2022); Tennyson, Cantos 54-56 from *In Memoriam* (1850); Browning, "The Cry of the Children" (1843).

Reflective Project 2 due Sunday, Nov 2nd, at 11:59PM.

Week 11 Disease II

T Nov 4 Nordau, Selections from *Degeneration* (1892); Stevenson, *Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde* (1886).

TH Nov 6 Sciampacone, "'Epidemics in a Mist'" (2020), Stevenson, *Jekyll and Hyde* (1886).

Week 12 Populations II

T Nov 11 Lanzarotta, "From Farms to Pharma" (2024); Wells, *The Island of Doctor Moreau* (1896).

TH Nov 13 Danahay, "Wells, Galton and Biopower: Breeding Human Animals" (2012); Wells, *The Island of Doctor Moreau* (1896).

Week 13 The Physician II

T Nov 18 Durbach, "Vampires, Vivisectors, and the Victorian Body" (2005); Braddon, "Good Lady Ducayne" (1896).

TH Nov 20 Pamboukian, "The 'Wretched Italian Quack'" (2015); Braddon, "Good Lady Ducayne" (1896).

Week 14 Thanksgiving Asynchronous Project

T Nov 25 Asynchronous Project (No class).

TH Nov 27 Thanksgiving!

Week 15 Medicine and Power II

T Dec 2 Gamlin et al., "The biopolitics of COVD-19 in the UK" (2021); Vyas et al., "Hidden in Plain Sight - Reconsidering the Use of Race Correction in Clinical Algorithms" (2020).

TH Dec 4 Siddiqi, "The Cesspool of Empire" (2006); Doyle, "The Speckled Band" (1892).

Week 16 Workshop

T Dec 10 Workshop for Reflective Project 3/Final Project.

Reflective Project 3 due Sunday, Dec 14th, at 11:59PM.